

	Division/Section	Family Support
	Chapter No./Name	4 – Economic Stability (ES)
	Part No./Name	P – Strategies to Empower People (STEP) Program
	Section No./Name	P-500-STEP Sanctions/Good Cause
	Document No./Name	P-510-STEP Sanctions
	Effective Date	February 15, 2024

I. STATEMENT OF POLICY

P-510-STEP - PO SANCTIONS

* An intensified, coaching case management approach allows staff to learn more about our participants and to offer opportunities to help our participants address and resolve their challenges. The STEP sanction philosophy must be fair, but it must hold our participants accountable and responsible for their success in overcoming these challenges. **

Sanctions are to be used as a last resort when FITAP work-eligible families have not met the required expectations of the STEP Program. A sanction is not considered a punishment, but is a consequence of not meeting program expectations.

II. PROCEDURES

P-510-STEP - PR SANCTIONS

*** * Coaches must fully explain the expectations of the STEP program and the relevance for remaining in the program. These expectations and consequences must be explained to the participant in detail during completion of the Family Success Agreement. In review and revise sessions, STEP coaches are expected to revisit the importance of participation. The STEP Coach must assist the participant in solving problems that arise. Solutions to these problems, good cause consideration, and potential sanctions must be discussed in supervisory conference.

Person Notes must contain adequate documentation that participants were informed of their expectations and consequences during the completion of the Family Success Agreement.

If good cause is explored and cannot be established, the appropriate STEP sanction must be requested and applied in a fair and consistent manner. In LITE, search for and access the participant's referral and then navigate to the *Request a Sanction* tab, and click on the *Create New Sanction* button to send an automated request to the ES Case Maintenance worker, who will impose the sanction on the participant's eligibility case. If the participant complies with STEP during the 13-day period of advance adverse action, the STEP Coach must contact the ES worker manually to cancel the sanction request.

Once sanctioned, the STEP Coach must work with the participant if they reapply for cash assistance to cure their sanction by first understanding the challenges and barriers that may have led to the sanction. The STEP Coach must then work with the participant to jointly determine solutions to those challenges in order to help participants be more successful in STEP **

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III. FORMS AND INSTRUCTIONS

There are no forms associated with this policy.

IV. REFERENCES

[LAC 67](#): III.5717